



Whale shark

Out of the ocean depths, a mighty mouth comes into view. At 1.5 m (5 ft) wide, a human could easily fit inside it, however, this mouth belongs to the whale shark – a gentle giant. Though its huge jaws have 3,000 teeth, they are tiny and useless for biting. Unlike its more carnivorous cousins, the whale shark feeds by sucking in great mouthfuls of water, then filtering out algae, fish and coral eggs, shrimp, and baby fish to eat.

This spotty shark doesn't just have a big mouth – it is the biggest fish on Earth. It grows longer than a double-decker bus and is heavier than two full-size elephants!



Whale shark,
Worldwide